

Thato Morelle Kekana

Senior Test Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Test Automation Engineer with 12+ years of software testing experience across banking, payments, insurance, and loyalty rewards. I build and evolve automation frameworks for web, API, and mobile: Playwright and TypeScript for web, Maestro for mobile, and API checks alongside, running in Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines. I work AI-first, using spec-driven development with Kiro, AI agents driving real browsers and devices through MCP servers (Playwright MCP, Maestro MCP), multi-agent requirements verification, and automated evidence-grade reporting and Test Closure Reports. I design and build unified test automation frameworks that bring web, mobile, and API testing together behind a single model, with network mocking, requirement traceability, and tamper-evident evidence reporting, and I build and continuously improve AI testing agents by equipping them with reusable skills and tools. I am detail-focused, analytical, and I mentor engineers on automation best practice.

CORE SKILLS

Test Automation: Playwright, Maestro, Selenium WebDriver, Appium, Cucumber (BDD), TestNG, Maven

Languages: TypeScript, Java, Python, SQL

API Testing: REST Assured, Karate, SoapUI, Postman, Bruno

CI/CD and Tooling: Azure DevOps Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Git, Jira, Xray, Kibana, HP Quality Center

Data and ETL Testing: Great Expectations, SQL, NoSQL databases, test data management

AI-Assisted Testing: MCP test servers (Playwright MCP, Maestro MCP), multi-agent test orchestration, spec-driven development with Kiro, AI-assisted test design, AI-powered failure analysis, AI-generated test evidence and reporting, agentic test workflows, building and skilling AI testing agents

Framework Engineering: test platform architecture, driver abstractions, network mocking and HAR record-and-replay, TLS interception, tamper-evident evidence packs, requirement traceability, flake detection and quarantine

Practices: Agile, Scrum, test strategy, test planning, regression testing, smoke and sanity testing, UAT, integration testing, defect management, visual regression testing, accessibility testing (axe), mentoring

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Test Automation Engineer

Standard Bank (UCount Rewards) | Johannesburg | Jun 2024 - Present

- Develop and maintain a scalable Playwright and TypeScript test framework, reused across teams, covering the programme's public and authenticated web journeys with stable role-based locators, web-first assertions, and no hard waits.
- Automate API checks alongside UI tests in the same repository, and build mobile UI test flows with Maestro alongside the web framework.
- Built a unified test automation framework that brings web (Playwright), mobile (Maestro, Appium), and API testing together behind a single typed action model, with network mocking and HAR record-and-replay, requirement traceability, flake detection with automatic quarantine, and tamper-evident evidence packs.
- Run suites in Azure DevOps pipelines on every pull request and on a daily schedule, publishing Playwright HTML reports as pipeline artifacts; use Playwright projects, devices, retries, and traces for reliability and debugging.
- Perform requirements-based testing against the bank's documented requirements, maintaining a structured, testable requirements baseline with traceability from requirement to test to evidence.
- Accelerate coverage by orchestrating swarms of parallel AI verification agents, with a lead agent independently reviewing and verifying each agent's findings before they are accepted, producing

evidence-quoted verdicts.

- Build and continuously improve AI testing agents: equip them with reusable skills, custom tools, and MCP server integrations (Playwright MCP, Maestro MCP) so their capability grows with every engagement.
- Drive real browsers and mobile simulators with AI agents through MCP servers to explore user journeys and capture evidence; promote reviewed agent-authored flows into the regression suites.
- Apply spec-driven development with Kiro, keeping requirements, design, and task spec files as the single source of truth that implementation and tests are verified against.
- Automated Test Closure Report assembly into branded HTML and A4 PDF with desktop and mobile screenshot evidence, severity-rated findings registers, and axe accessibility checks; produce dev-ready defect logs with reproduction steps and impact.
- Run smoke, sanity, and regression suites for every release; manage test data and environment configuration across local, SIT, and pipeline runs.
- Track quality with pass rate, flaky-test, and time-to-detect metrics; coach junior engineers on clean TypeScript tests and Playwright best practice.

Senior Test Automation Engineer

RMB (Rand Merchant Bank) | Johannesburg | Sep 2022 - Jun 2024

- Identified and implemented Great Expectations as the ETL data-testing tool for data-heavy platforms.
- Owned test planning, test requirement analysis, and test data generation and retrieval.
- Created the regression test pack and automated test case scripts.
- Performed API testing with SoapUI and Postman, and supported UAT.
- Executed test scripts, identified and logged defects, and retested fixes through to closure.

Test Automation Engineer

BankservAfrica | Johannesburg | Sep 2021 - Aug 2022

- Helped create the test automation framework from scratch for Africa's largest payments clearing house.
- Built the regression test pack and automated priority test cases.
- Ran UAT with external testing partners.
- Performed API testing with SoapUI and Postman.

QA Engineer

Stellr | Johannesburg | Jul 2019 - Aug 2021

- Created a BDD test automation framework from scratch.
- Tested end-to-end card and voucher platform flows, including integration testing with SoapUI and Postman.
- Manipulated and validated test data across SQL and NoSQL databases.
- Wrote test plans, designed and prioritised test cases, and documented results.
- Tracked bugs, handled change requests, and helped developers reproduce incidents.

Test Analyst

BankservAfrica | Johannesburg | Nov 2016 - May 2019

- Designed, prioritised, and executed test cases for national payment systems.
- Manipulated and validated data with SQL; generated test data for execution.
- Supported UAT and end-to-end testing; reviewed system requirement specifications.
- Logged defects, tracked them to closure, and helped developers reproduce incidents.

Tester, then Test Analyst (Enterprise Testing)

Nedbank | Johannesburg | Jan 2014 - Oct 2016

- Tested WAP, USSD, and app suites across Android, iOS, BlackBerry, and Windows devices.
- Performed regression, integration, black-box, and negative testing; validated results against expected outcomes.
- Created and updated test cases from user stories and recorded and assigned defects.
- Contributed to sprint planning, backlog grooming, retrospectives, and daily scrums.
- Mentored and upskilled new and junior staff.

Test Analyst

First National Bank (FNB) | Johannesburg | Jan 2014 - Aug 2014

- Executed manual functional tests from HP Quality Center.
- Tested apps on tablets and phones across iOS, BlackBerry, and Android.
- Captured and reported defects in HP Quality Center.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Portfolio Website

morelleddev.github.io/thato-cv | 2026

- Built and shipped an interactive CV site (Angular, TypeScript, WebGL) with an automated GitHub Actions pipeline deploying to GitHub Pages on every push.

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISTQB Advanced Test Analyst, SASTQB, 2017
- ISEB Intermediate Certificate in Software Testing, BCS The Chartered Institute for IT, 2016
- ISTQB Foundation Level, BCS The Chartered Institute for IT, 2014

EDUCATION

- BSc Computer Systems, CTI, 2014
- Matric (National Senior Certificate), Hebron Model School, 2010